PwC Digital Strategy

Evidence Map: Themes and Supporting Interview Evidence

Version 2, updated with follow-up Interview | Draft for discussion | 31 October 2026

1. Version note and basis

This is version 2 of the evidence map. It supersedes version 1 (Evidence_Map.docx), which is unchanged. Version 2 adds evidence from the follow-up interview (Int-09, Client Executive Sponsor) and nothing else. No new data has been created. The themes, original quotes and original strength ratings are carried over from version 1.

The original evidence is the eight interview transcripts (Int-01 to Int-08). The follow-up evidence is Int-09, a fictional practice transcript in which a client sponsor answers the open questions. Every statement in both sets is stakeholder opinion or reported status. None is independently verified, and the follow-up statements describe the client's process status, not facts about the target.

Evidence strength is a qualitative judgement of consistency across stakeholders. It is not a statistic, and it is not a measure of importance. No theme is rated above Moderate. No strength rating changed in version 2, because the follow-up confirms gaps but supplies no verified evidence.

Strength	Meaning
Moderate	Raised consistently by stakeholders in different functions, but still unverified opinion.
Low to moderate	A smaller number of voices, or a general principle with no target-specific content.
Low	Essentially one voice.
Unvalidated	A consultant inference with no direct statement behind it.

Orange shading	Marks evidence from the follow-up interview (Int-09). Follow-up statements carry IDs FU-01 to FU-26 and are listed in the appendix.

Statement IDs (ST-xx) refer to the statement register in the earlier report. Quotes marked "(interview text)" are exact transcript quotes that are not in the register.

2. Summary map

ID	Theme	Stakeholders (Int-01 to 08)	v1 strength	v2 strength	Follow-up evidence (Int-09)
T1	A large or growing market does not show the target can capture it	S1, S2, S7, S8	Moderate	No change	FU-01, FU-02, FU-03
T2	Management claims need independent verification	S1, S2, S3, S4, S5, S6, S8	Moderate	No change	FU-06, FU-07, FU-08, FU-09, FU-25
T3	Advantages and relationships may not transfer or survive a change of ownership	S1, S2, S8	Low to moderate	No change	FU-22, FU-23
T4	Regulatory and local access steps determine timing and cost	S4, S8, S1, S2	Moderate	No change	FU-05, FU-24, FU-26
T5	Integration could threaten patient safety, availability and continuity	S3, S7, S5	Low to moderate	No change	FU-19, FU-20, FU-21
T6	Health data, cyber and system integrity are a gating exposure	S5	Low	No change	FU-02, FU-17, FU-18

ID	Theme	Stakeholders (Int-01 to 08)	v1 strength	v2 strength	Follow-up evidence (Int-09)
T7	Total acquisition cost may exceed the headline price	S6, S3, S4, S5, S1	Low to moderate	No change	FU-10, FU-06, FU-08
T8	Most risk and evidence needs depend on what the target actually is	S2, S3, S4, S5, S6, S7	Moderate (method only)	No change	FU-01, FU-02, FU-03, FU-04, FU-05, FU-26
T9	Stakeholders set conditions for pausing, escalating or qualifying the decision	S1, S3, S4, S6	Low to moderate	No change	FU-10, FU-11, FU-12, FU-13, FU-25
T10	The speed rationale conflicts with approval and integration constraints	S1 vs S2, S4, S7, S8	Unvalidated	Unvalidated (conflict); narrower claim now stated by client	FU-14, FU-15, FU-16, FU-24

3. What changed in version 2

Theme	Follow-up change	Effect
T1	Target partly described (management account). No market evidence added.	Gap partially addressed
T2	Client confirms nothing is independently verified and the data room is not open.	Gap confirmed
T3	Customer contact restricted; reviewers only after the data room opens.	Constraint added to validation
T4	Regulatory pathway for Market B unconfirmed; decision date not fixed.	Gap confirmed
T5	No integration plan; stop authority undefined; integrate-or-separate undecided.	Gap confirmed
T6	Platform collects device data per management; data rights, storage and cross-border flow unknown.	Gap partially addressed and partly confirmed
T7	Thresholds not approved; financial information summary-level and unverified.	Gap confirmed
T8	Business description, products and two markets given, as management's account.	Gap partially addressed
T9	Expected gate owners named but not agreed; escalation effect undecided.	Gap partially addressed
T10	Client says acquisition preference rests on a belief that it is faster; no criteria or timelines.	Narrower claim supported by stakeholder statement; conflict claim unvalidated

4. Theme evidence maps

T1. A large or growing market does not show the target can capture it

Proposed insight	Demand growth cannot be assumed to convert into revenue or deliverable volume for this target.
Stakeholders	Original interviews (Int-01 to Int-08): S1, S2, S7, S8 Follow-up: Client Executive Sponsor (Int-09), who is not one of S1 to S8
Exact supporting quotes (original interviews)	S1, ST-02: "A broad statement that healthcare demand is growing is not enough to justify this target or its valuation." S2, ST-07: "Market growth does not automatically become revenue for one company." S8, ST-37: "Do not equate a large healthcare market with an accessible market." S7, ST-32: "A market forecast does not tell us whether the target can safely deliver the extra demand."

FOLLOW-UP INTERVIEW EVIDENCE (Int-09)	FU-01 (Int-09, Q1): "The target is a mid-sized medical technology company." FU-02 (Int-09, Q1): "It makes two lines of connected medical devices and sells a cloud-based monitoring platform that collects data from them." FU-03 (Int-09, Q1): "That description comes from management's own presentation." What it adds: Describes the target and its current market per management's account. It adds no market size, demand or competitor evidence.
Evidence strength	Moderate. Four functions (strategy, commercial, country, operations) make the same point from different angles. All are cautions, unverified, and say nothing specific about this target. v2 update: No change. The follow-up adds no market evidence.
Contradictory / alternative evidence	None found. No stakeholder argues that market size alone is sufficient. v2 update: None found.
Evidence gaps (original)	The target's segments, countries and customers. Actual demand, competitor position and capacity. All are Not established in transcript.
GAP STATUS AFTER FOLLOW-UP (Int-09)	Partially addressed: the target is now described (FU-01, FU-02), but as management's account (FU-03). Still open: segments, demand, competitor position and capacity. The follow-up gives no market data.
Recommended validation	Build a segment-level, source-traced market and competitor map. Test target capacity against the forecast. Validate with customer references.

T2. Management claims need independent verification

Proposed insight	Stakeholders across functions want original or independently verified records in place of management assertions.
Stakeholders	Original interviews (Int-01 to Int-08): S1, S2, S3, S4, S5, S6, S8 (S7 is related) Follow-up: Client Executive Sponsor (Int-09), who is not one of S1 to S8
Exact supporting quotes (original interviews)	S1 (interview text): "We should show what we know, what management claims, and what remains untested." S2, ST-08: "rather than relying only on the target's pitch deck." S3, ST-11: "Marketing material and testimonials alone do not establish clinical benefit." S4, ST-17: "We should reconcile management's answers with original records." S5, ST-23: "A policy document alone does not prove controls work." S6, ST-28: "Reconcile reported revenue to contracts, invoices, cash collections and underlying activity." S8, ST-41: "which assumptions are supported by customer evidence rather than management optimism." S7, ST-34 (related): "Definitions and historical trends matter more than a one-off snapshot."
FOLLOW-UP INTERVIEW EVIDENCE (Int-09)	FU-06 (Int-09, Q2): "Management has given us a presentation, summary financial information and a high-level regulatory overview." FU-07 (Int-09, Q2): "The data room has not been opened to us yet." FU-08 (Int-09, Q2): "Nothing has been independently verified." FU-09 (Int-09, Q2): "So everything we currently believe about the Target is management's account." FU-25 (Int-09, Q8): "If we cannot verify something by then, I would rather the committee see it flagged than assumed." What it adds: The client sponsor confirms that nothing has been independently verified and that the data room is not yet open. This corroborates the gap that the evidence standard addresses. It does not verify or refute any claim.

Evidence strength	Moderate. Consistent across most functions. It describes an evidence standard, not a finding about the target. v2 update: No change. The follow-up shows the standard has not yet been met. It adds no verified evidence.
Contradictory / alternative evidence	None. S7 frames the same need as definitions and trends, not independent verification. v2 update: None. The sponsor's stated preference to have unverified items flagged rather than assumed (FU-25) is consistent with S1's request.
Evidence gaps (original)	What management has claimed is Not established in transcript. No claims or source documents were supplied.
GAP STATUS AFTER FOLLOW-UP (Int-09)	Partially addressed: management has provided a presentation, summary financial information and a high-level regulatory overview (FU-06). Their content was not supplied. Confirmed open: nothing is independently verified (FU-08), and the data room is not open (FU-07).
Recommended validation	Build an evidence register that separates verified facts, management claims and untested assumptions. Issue a data request for original records.

T3. Advantages and relationships may not transfer or survive a change of ownership

Proposed insight	The thesis may rely on relationships, reputation and capabilities that are not exclusive, may be personal, or may not move to new markets.
Stakeholders	Original interviews (Int-01 to Int-08): S1, S2, S8 Follow-up: Client Executive Sponsor (Int-09), who is not one of S1 to S8
Exact supporting quotes (original interviews)	S1 (interview text): "the target's reputation and capabilities do not transfer to our intended markets" S1, ST-04: "If the rationale depends on a market-entry advantage that is not exclusive" S2, ST-10: "The team may assume that existing relationships automatically travel across borders or that our current sales force can cross-sell immediately." S8, ST-38: "If relationships depend on one founder or a few individuals, we need to know whether those people will remain and whether the relationships are institutional or personal." S8, ST-40: "Would a change of ownership affect trust, contracts, service, or purchasing decisions?"
FOLLOW-UP INTERVIEW EVIDENCE (Int-09)	FU-22 (Int-09, Q7): "Contact with the Target's customers is not permitted at this stage." FU-23 (Int-09, Q7): "Independent reviewers, such as quality and legal specialists, can be engaged through advisers, but only once the data room opens." What it adds: Customer contact is currently not permitted, and independent reviewers can be engaged only once the data room opens. This limits how soon transfer and exclusivity can be tested.
Evidence strength	Low to moderate. Three stakeholders agree, but every statement is conditional ("may", "if"). None says the problem exists. v2 update: No change. The follow-up gives no evidence on whether advantages transfer.
Contradictory / alternative evidence	None direct. S1's "attraction is speed" (ST-01a) assumes some advantage exists, and S1 also says that is "not yet shown" (ST-01b). v2 update: None found.
Evidence gaps (original)	Contract terms including change of control; customer views; whether key-person dependence exists. All Not established in transcript.

GAP STATUS AFTER FOLLOW-UP (Int-09)	Constrained: customer views cannot currently be gathered (FU-22). Still open: contract terms, key-person dependence and exclusivity of advantages. The follow-up does not address them.
Recommended validation	Review customer contracts and change-of-control clauses. Interview customers and local partners. Map who holds each key relationship. v2 note: Customer interviews depend on the client lifting the current restriction (FU-22). Reviewers can be engaged once the data room opens (FU-23).

T4. Regulatory and local access steps determine timing and cost

Proposed insight	Approvals, tenders and other local steps are country-specific and could delay entry. The forecast needs to model them.
Stakeholders	Original interviews (Int-01 to Int-08): S4, S8, S1, S2 Follow-up: Client Executive Sponsor (Int-09), who is not one of S1 to S8
Exact supporting quotes (original interviews)	S4, ST-16: "We must not assume one country's approval works everywhere." S4, ST-19: "The forecast should model the relevant pathway, not simply assume a launch date." S8, ST-39: "Local registration or licensing steps, procurement cycles, reimbursement decisions where applicable, onboarding requirements, customer approvals, language and service expectations, or gaps in local support." S1 (interview text): "required approvals or access channels are uncertain" S2 (interview text): "tender rules, reimbursement or budget constraints"
FOLLOW-UP INTERVIEW EVIDENCE (Int-09)	FU-05 (Int-09, Q1 follow-up): "Our regulatory team has not confirmed the pathway for Market B." FU-24 (Int-09, Q8): "The decision is currently planned for the end of next quarter, although the date is not fixed." FU-26 (Int-09, Q1): "It currently operates in one market, which I will call Market A. The market we are considering entering is Market B." What it adds: The regulatory pathway for Market B is not confirmed, and the decision date is not fixed.
Evidence strength	Moderate. Four stakeholders in different roles agree. These are general statements, unverified, with no target data. v2 update: No change. The follow-up confirms the pathway is unconfirmed but adds no regulatory data.
Contradictory / alternative evidence	Tension, not contradiction (consultant inference): S1 gives "speed" as the attraction. No timeline is stated, so the tension is unvalidated. v2 update: No change. The follow-up gives no timeline, so the tension remains unvalidated.
Evidence gaps (original)	Target's products, countries, licences, regulator history, and time and cost to obtain missing approvals. Not established in transcript.
GAP STATUS AFTER FOLLOW-UP (Int-09)	Partially addressed: the target is described as having two device lines and a platform, per management (FU-02), and Market B is the market under consideration (FU-26). Still open: the approval pathway for Market B (FU-05), licences, regulator history, and time and cost of missing approvals.
Recommended validation	Map licences and approvals by country with legal and regulatory specialists. Compare acquisition, partnership and organic entry timelines.

T5. Integration could threaten patient safety, availability and continuity

Proposed insight	Changes of ownership, suppliers, systems or processes could disrupt safe operation if not controlled.
Stakeholders	Original interviews (Int-01 to Int-08): S3, S7, S5 Follow-up: Client Executive Sponsor (Int-09), who is not one of S1 to S8

Exact supporting quotes (original interviews)	S3, ST-13: "Yes. A change in ownership, supplier, system, service location, or clinical process can affect availability or continuity." S7, ST-35: "Changing suppliers, systems, processes or leadership too quickly can disrupt availability, care workflows, service levels or quality." S5, ST-24: "Poor migration or interoperability can interrupt workflows, make records unavailable, break interfaces, or compromise data integrity."
FOLLOW-UP INTERVIEW EVIDENCE (Int-09)	FU-19 (Int-09, Q5): "We have not decided whether to integrate the Target's platform into our systems or keep it separate." FU-20 (Int-09, Q6): "There is no integration plan." FU-21 (Int-09, Q6): "Authority to stop a change is not defined." What it adds: The client confirms there is no integration plan, no defined authority to stop a change, and no decision on whether to integrate the platform or keep it separate.
Evidence strength	Low to moderate. Three stakeholders give consistent warnings, but they are general risk statements. None cites an incident or target-specific dependency. v2 update: No change. The follow-up shows the safeguards S7 asks for are not yet in place, but it gives no evidence on actual disruption risk.
Contradictory / alternative evidence	None direct. S7's "too quickly" differs from S1's speed emphasis, but S1's speed refers to market entry. That link is a consultant inference and is unvalidated. v2 update: No change.
Evidence gaps (original)	Critical products and services, dependencies, integration plan, and who can stop an unsafe change. Not established in transcript.
GAP STATUS AFTER FOLLOW-UP (Int-09)	Confirmed open: no integration plan (FU-20) and no defined stop authority (FU-21). Still open: critical products and services and their dependencies. The integrate-or-separate decision is undecided (FU-19).
Recommended validation	Build a critical-operations map. Review the integration roadmap and continuity plan. Define what must remain stable.

T6. Health data, cyber and system integrity are a gating exposure

Proposed insight	The target's data practices and cyber controls need examination, and technology or data-protection concerns could affect adoption and cost.
Stakeholders	Original interviews (Int-01 to Int-08): S5 (primary); S2 and S6 (brief mentions) Follow-up: Client Executive Sponsor (Int-09), who is not one of S1 to S8
Exact supporting quotes (original interviews)	S5, ST-23: "A policy document alone does not prove controls work." S5, ST-22: "What personal or health data is collected, why it is used, where it is stored, …" S2 (interview text): "clinicians and data-protection teams can still block implementation" S6 (interview text): "technology and cyber upgrades"
FOLLOW-UP INTERVIEW EVIDENCE (Int-09)	FU-02 (Int-09, Q1): "It makes two lines of connected medical devices and sells a cloud-based monitoring platform that collects data from them." FU-17 (Int-09, Q5): "That is an aspiration, not a plan." FU-18 (Int-09, Q5): "We do not know what rights the Target has over that data, where it is stored, or whether it crosses borders." What it adds: Management's description says the platform collects data from the devices. The client says the rights over that data, where it is stored and whether it crosses borders are unknown, and treats AI or analytics use as an aspiration, not a plan.
Evidence strength	Low. One stakeholder develops this in depth, and the other two mention it in passing. This reflects the transcripts' coverage, not importance. v2 update: No change (Low). The follow-up adds a client-side statement that data rights are unknown, but still no evidence on controls.

Contradictory / alternative evidence	None. v2 update: None.
Evidence gaps (original)	Whether the target holds health data, its system inventory, breach history and test results. Not established in transcript.
GAP STATUS AFTER FOLLOW-UP (Int-09)	Partially addressed: the platform collects data from devices per management (FU-02). Whether it is personal or health data is still not stated. Confirmed open: data rights, storage location and cross-border flow are unknown (FU-18).
Recommended validation	Request a data-flow and system inventory, penetration-test results and incident history. Obtain a technical review.

T7. Total acquisition cost may exceed the headline price

Proposed insight	Remediation, technology, integration and working-capital costs may be missing from the headline valuation and need quantifying.
Stakeholders	Original interviews (Int-01 to Int-08): S6, S3, S4, S5, S1 Follow-up: Client Executive Sponsor (Int-09), who is not one of S1 to S8
Exact supporting quotes (original interviews)	S6, ST-29: "liabilities that are not obvious from the headline valuation." S3, ST-15: "uncosted remediation plan" S4, ST-20: "a remediation requirement with no credible owner, cost, or timeline" S5, ST-26: "Cyber remediation, licence and vendor costs, data migration, interoperability, …" S6, ST-30: "The team should show the impact on cash flow and returns rather than just describe risks." S1 (interview text): "a downside case"
FOLLOW-UP INTERVIEW EVIDENCE (Int-09)	FU-10 (Int-09, Q3): "The board has not approved investment thresholds." FU-06 (Int-09, Q2): "Management has given us a presentation, summary financial information and a high-level regulatory overview." FU-08 (Int-09, Q2): "Nothing has been independently verified." What it adds: Investment thresholds are not approved. The financial information received is summary-level and has not been independently verified.
Evidence strength	Low to moderate. Several functions point to costs, but all speak in conditionals. ST-29 is classed ambiguous in the classification review. v2 update: No change. The follow-up gives no cost or valuation information.
Contradictory / alternative evidence	None. No stakeholder reports that a remediation need or hidden liability exists. v2 update: None found.
Evidence gaps (original)	Valuation, financials, any quantified cost. Not established in transcript.
GAP STATUS AFTER FOLLOW-UP (Int-09)	Confirmed open: investment thresholds are not approved (FU-10). Still open: valuation, financials and quantified costs. The follow-up supplies none.
Recommended validation	Commission independent quality-of-earnings work. Cost remediation items after quality, regulatory and cyber reviews. Build downside cases in the model.

T8. Most risk and evidence needs depend on what the target actually is

Proposed insight	Until the target's business model, countries and products are known, risks and evidence needs cannot be specified or prioritised.
Stakeholders	Original interviews (Int-01 to Int-08): S2, S3, S4, S5, S6, S7 Follow-up: Client Executive Sponsor (Int-09), who is not one of S1 to S8
Exact supporting	S2 (interview text): "That depends on the business model."

quotes (original interviews)	S6 (interview text): "That depends on the target." S3 (interview text): "The precise list depends on what the target actually does." S4 (interview text): "First, list the target's actual products and services and every country in which it operates or plans to enter."
FOLLOW-UP INTERVIEW EVIDENCE (Int-09)	FU-01 (Int-09, Q1): "The target is a mid-sized medical technology company." FU-02 (Int-09, Q1): "It makes two lines of connected medical devices and sells a cloud-based monitoring platform that collects data from them." FU-03 (Int-09, Q1): "That description comes from management's own presentation." FU-04 (Int-09, Q1): "We have not yet seen product-level detail, and I cannot yet tell you whether the platform is sold separately from the devices." FU-05 (Int-09, Q1 follow-up): "Our regulatory team has not confirmed the pathway for Market B." FU-26 (Int-09, Q1): "It currently operates in one market, which I will call Market A. The market we are considering entering is Market B." What it adds: The target is now partly described, but only by management's account. Product-level detail has not been seen, and whether the platform is sold separately is not known.
Evidence strength	Moderate as a statement about method, since the stakeholders agree. It says nothing about the target itself. v2 update: No change. The target is partly described, but only by management's account (FU-03), so nothing about the target is validated.
Contradictory / alternative evidence	None. v2 update: None.
Evidence gaps (original)	Target identity, business model, countries and products. Not established in transcript.
GAP STATUS AFTER FOLLOW-UP (Int-09)	Partially addressed: a business description, product types and two markets (A current, B under consideration) are given (FU-01, FU-02, FU-26), as management's account. Still open: product-level detail and whether the platform is sold separately (FU-04); the regulatory pathway for Market B (FU-05).
Recommended validation	Obtain the target's business description and product/country list before the next evidence request. v2 note: Verify the management description against source documents once the data room opens (FU-07).

T9. Stakeholders set conditions for pausing, escalating or qualifying the decision

Proposed insight	Four stakeholders hold distinct decision gates, and there is no agreed shared framework.
Stakeholders	Original interviews (Int-01 to Int-08): S1, S3, S4, S6 Follow-up: Client Executive Sponsor (Int-09), who is not one of S1 to S8
Exact supporting quotes (original interviews)	S1 (interview text): "I would also pause if we cannot explain why acquisition is better than partnership or organic entry." S3, ST-15: "should be escalated before commitment" S4 (interview text): "These issues need legal and regulatory review before the team recommends proceeding." S6, ST-31: "If critical assumptions cannot be validated, the recommendation may need to be conditional or the decision paused."

FOLLOW-UP INTERVIEW EVIDENCE (Int-09)	FU-10 (Int-09, Q3): "The board has not approved investment thresholds." FU-11 (Int-09, Q3): "I would expect the Chief Medical Officer and the Regulatory Director to be able to escalate a safety or compliance concern, and the CFO to own the financial gate." FU-12 (Int-09, Q3): "But that is my expectation. It has not been written down or agreed." FU-13 (Int-09, Q3 follow-up): "That has not been decided." FU-25 (Int-09, Q8): "If we cannot verify something by then, I would rather the committee see it flagged than assumed." What it adds: The client names expected escalation owners (CMO, Regulatory Director, CFO) but says this is an expectation, not an agreement. Thresholds are not approved, and whether escalation stops the process is undecided.
Evidence strength	Low to moderate. The gates are stated clearly, but their relationship and thresholds are not. v2 update: No change. The follow-up confirms there is no agreed framework yet.
Contradictory / alternative evidence	Difference in framing: S6 allows a "conditional" outcome, while S1, S3 and S4 describe pausing or escalating. This may reflect different roles and is unvalidated as a disagreement. v2 update: Follow-up observation: the named escalation owners in FU-11 do not include a named owner for S1's pause criteria.
Evidence gaps (original)	Whether any gate currently applies. The client's investment thresholds. Not established in transcript.
GAP STATUS AFTER FOLLOW-UP (Int-09)	Partially addressed: expected gate owners are named (FU-11), but not agreed (FU-12). Confirmed open: thresholds not approved (FU-10); effect of escalation undecided (FU-13). Whether any gate currently applies remains not established.
Recommended validation	Agree a single decision-gate framework with the client, and record the thresholds.

T10. The speed rationale conflicts with approval and integration constraints (UNVALIDATED)

Proposed insight	Speed may not materialise if approvals, tenders and integration constraints delay benefits.
Stakeholders	Original interviews (Int-01 to Int-08): S1 against S2, S4, S7, S8 Follow-up: Client Executive Sponsor (Int-09), who is not one of S1 to S8
Exact supporting quotes (original interviews)	S1, ST-01a: "The attraction is speed." Counterpoints are in T4 and T5. No stakeholder links the two statements.
FOLLOW-UP INTERVIEW EVIDENCE (Int-09)	FU-14 (Int-09, Q4): "Both are still open in principle." FU-15 (Int-09, Q4): "We have not set criteria for comparing the three routes." FU-16 (Int-09, Q4): "At the moment the preference for acquisition rests on a belief that it is faster, and nobody has put a timeline against each option." FU-24 (Int-09, Q8): "The decision is currently planned for the end of next quarter, although the date is not fixed." What it adds: The client sponsor says the preference for acquisition rests on a belief that it is faster, with no comparison criteria and no timeline for each route.
Evidence strength	Unvalidated. This is a consultant inference from comparing separate statements. No interviewee says speed is at risk, and no timelines are given. v2 update: Conflict claim: still unvalidated. A narrower claim, that the speed advantage has not been tested, is now stated directly by the client sponsor (FU-16), as a stakeholder statement and not an independent finding.

Contradictory / alternative evidence	S1's "speed" refers to entry, while S4, S7 and S8 refer to timing, and they may not conflict at all. v2 update: No change.
Evidence gaps (original)	Timelines for acquisition, partnership and organic entry. Not established in transcript.
GAP STATUS AFTER FOLLOW-UP (Int-09)	Confirmed open: no comparison criteria (FU-15) and no timeline per option (FU-16). Partnership and organic entry remain open (FU-14). Still open: the decision date is planned but not fixed (FU-24).
Recommended validation	Build a comparative timeline for the three entry routes before treating speed as an advantage.

5. Conclusions the transcripts do not support

The following are all unvalidated. The follow-up does not change them.

- That acquisition is better than partnership or organic entry. S1 states this has not been shown, and the client sponsor says no comparison criteria exist (FU-15).
- That the target has any exclusive advantage, strong quality record, valid licences or sound finances.
- That any red flag or gate trigger currently applies.
- That any theme is more important than another. The themes are not ranked, and the number of stakeholders raising one is not a measure of importance.
- That any figure, date or amount about the target is known. The follow-up gives a planned decision timing only (FU-24), not a fixed date.
- That management's description of the target (FU-01, FU-02) is accurate. It has not been verified (FU-08).

6. Priority validation actions, with follow-up status

1. Obtain the target's business model, countries and products (T8). Most other checks depend on this.

   Follow-up status (Int-09): Partly provided as a management description (FU-01 to FU-05). It still needs verification, and the data room is not open (FU-07).

2. Issue a data request for original records covering regulatory, quality, contract, data and financial areas (T2, T3, T4, T6, T7).

   Follow-up status (Int-09): Nothing is yet verified (FU-08), and management has provided only a presentation, summary financials and a regulatory overview (FU-06).

3. Interview the people the interviewees named as missing: target management, customers, local partners, independent quality reviewers and legal specialists.

   Follow-up status (Int-09): Customer contact is not currently permitted (FU-22). Independent reviewers can be engaged once the data room opens (FU-23).

4. Agree a shared decision-gate framework and client thresholds (T9).

   Follow-up status (Int-09): Thresholds are not approved (FU-10). Gate owners are expected but not agreed (FU-11, FU-12).

5. Build a comparative timeline of the three entry routes (T4, T10).

   Follow-up status (Int-09): No comparison criteria or timelines exist yet (FU-15, FU-16).

Appendix: Follow-up statement register (Int-09)

Quotes are verbatim from the Interview 09 transcript, which is a fictional practice transcript. "Type" describes what kind of statement it is. "Themes" shows where it is used in this map.

ID	Question	Exact quote	Type	Themes
FU-01	Q1	"The target is a mid-sized medical technology company."	Management account, unverified	T1, T8
FU-02	Q1	"It makes two lines of connected medical devices and sells a cloud-based monitoring platform that collects data from them."	Management account, unverified	T1, T6, T8
FU-03	Q1	"That description comes from management's own presentation."	Stakeholder-reported status	T1, T8
FU-04	Q1	"We have not yet seen product-level detail, and I cannot yet tell you whether the platform is sold separately from the devices."	Stakeholder-reported status	T8
FU-05	Q1 follow-up	"Our regulatory team has not confirmed the pathway for Market B."	Stakeholder-reported status	T4, T8
FU-06	Q2	"Management has given us a presentation, summary financial information and a high-level regulatory overview."	Stakeholder-reported status	T2, T7
FU-07	Q2	"The data room has not been opened to us yet."	Stakeholder-reported status	T2
FU-08	Q2	"Nothing has been independently verified."	Stakeholder-reported status	T2, T7
FU-09	Q2	"So everything we currently believe about the Target is management's account."	Stakeholder-reported status	T2
FU-10	Q3	"The board has not approved investment thresholds."	Stakeholder-reported status	T7, T9
FU-11	Q3	"I would expect the Chief Medical Officer and the Regulatory Director to be able to escalate a safety or compliance concern, and the CFO to own the financial gate."	Stakeholder expectation (hypothesis)	T9
FU-12	Q3	"But that is my expectation. It has not been written down or agreed."	Stakeholder-reported status	T9
FU-13	Q3 follow-up	"That has not been decided."	Stakeholder-reported status (answer to whether CMO or Regulatory escalation would stop the process)	T9
FU-14	Q4	"Both are still open in principle."	Stakeholder-reported status	T10
FU-15	Q4	"We have not set criteria for comparing the three routes."	Stakeholder-reported status	T10
FU-16	Q4	"At the moment the preference for acquisition rests on a belief that it is faster, and nobody has put a timeline against each option."	Stakeholder-reported belief and status	T10
FU-17	Q5	"That is an aspiration, not a plan."	Stakeholder-reported status (about AI or analytics use of platform data)	T6
FU-18	Q5	"We do not know what rights the Target has over that data, where it is stored, or whether it crosses borders."	Stakeholder-reported status	T6
FU-19	Q5	"We have not decided whether to integrate the Target's platform into our systems or keep it separate."	Stakeholder-reported status	T5
FU-20	Q6	"There is no integration plan."	Stakeholder-reported status	T5
FU-21	Q6	"Authority to stop a change is not defined."	Stakeholder-reported status	T5
FU-22	Q7	"Contact with the Target's customers is not permitted at this stage."	Stakeholder-reported status	T3
FU-23	Q7	"Independent reviewers, such as quality and legal specialists, can be engaged through advisers, but only once the data room opens."	Stakeholder-reported status	T3
FU-24	Q8	"The decision is currently planned for the end of next quarter, although the date is not fixed."	Stakeholder-reported plan	T4, T10
FU-25	Q8	"If we cannot verify something by then, I would rather the committee see it flagged than assumed."	Stakeholder preference (opinion)	T2, T9
FU-26	Q1	"It currently operates in one market, which I will call Market A. The market we are considering entering is Market B."	Management account, unverified	T4, T8